Saint Discovery

FOR TEACHERS & CATECHISTS

Check a saint's story

Source-checking activity · 15–20 minutes

Choose a teacher-approved saint biography and one source it cites. Work in pairs or independently. Use your own words and cite the source you actually read.

1. Find a claim. Write one specific event or date from the biography and name the biography.

2. Check its source. Who produced it, and what does it say about the claim? Does it cite an earlier witness or record?

3. State what remains uncertain. Does the source describe tradition, give a range, or leave a detail unanswered? If you cannot check a detail, say so.

Worked example: A Vatican canonization booklet says Kateri Tekakwitha was baptized in 1676. It does not establish what she felt on that day. The date is supported by this account; her feelings remain unknown from this source.

4. Write a careful sentence about your own claim. Name the source and distinguish what it supports from what you cannot verify.

Source: Vatican canonization booklet, 2012 (St. Kateri Tekakwitha)

https://www.vatican.va/news_services/liturgy/libretti/2012/20121021.pdf

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